

## **Strong 2-♣ Opening**

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣ A

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠ 7

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♠ 4

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥ 4

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5  
 ♥ 10 5 3  
 ♦ 10 7 6 5 3  
 ♣ K 10 2

♠ A J 10 7 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 8 2

♣ Q 5 3



♠ 4 3

♥ Q 6 4

♦ J 9 4

♣ A J 9 7 4

♠ K Q 8 6

♥ A K J 2

♦ A K Q

♣ 8 6

SOUTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

NORTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give NORTH an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

NORTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which SOUTH passes.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 2♣    |
| Pass        | 2♠    | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass        | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣A    |       |      |       |

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9  
♥ A K 2  
♦ A 8 3  
♣ A J 7 4

♠ 4 2

♥ 10 9 4 3

♦ Q J 2

♣ K Q 10 2



♠ K 6 3

♥ Q 8 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 9 5 3

♠ J 10 8 7 5

♥ J 7 6

♦ 10 9 5

♣ 8 6

WEST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But EAST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

WEST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and EAST passes.

*West*

2♣

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠7

*North*

Pass

*East*

2NT

*South*

Pass

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 4  
♥ 9 6 4 3  
♦ Q J 9  
♣ J 7 6

♠ Q J 7 2  
♥ Q 10 7 5  
♦ 7 2  
♣ 8 5 4



♠ 10 8 3  
♥ K  
♦ K 10 8 5 4 3  
♣ Q 10 2

♠ A K 9  
♥ A J 8 2  
♦ A 6  
♣ A K 9 3

SOUTH opens 2♣ and NORTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

SOUTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead.

SOUTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So SOUTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and NORTH bids 4♥.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 2♣    |
| Pass        | 2♦    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass        | 3♣    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠4    |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6 3  
♥ Q 8 5  
♦ K 7 6 4  
♣ K J 3

♠ J 10 8 7  
♥ 4 3  
♦ Q J 10 9 5  
♣ 9 6

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A K 9  
♥ A K 2  
♦ A 8 3  
♣ A Q 7 4

♠ 5 4 2  
♥ J 10 9 7 6  
♦ 2  
♣ 10 8 5 2

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 2♣   | Pass  |
| 2NT         | Pass  | 3NT  | Pass  |
| 6NT         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6NT by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥4    |       |      |       |

WEST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to EAST's 2♣ opening bid.

EAST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

WEST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.